Contract and Supplier Change Voice Copilot

A voice module for procurement, legal, QA sign-offs, and defensible approvals.

What Was Delivered

A voice module used by procurement and legal teams to handle two daily risk zones without slowing the business down: **contract clause decisions** and **supplier or packaging change approvals**.

People ask by voice, the module pulls the exact rule that applies, and if the decision needs sign-off it creates the approval request with the right context and evidence instead of starting a long email chain.

How it behaves when it is not sure

If the module is missing the detail that changes the rule — like the site, product line, supplier name, material type, contract type, or customer tier — it asks for it before it answers. If the module cannot find an approved clause or a valid change path for a supplier substitution, it does not invent a safe-sounding answer. It creates a review request, notifies the correct owner, and attaches the clause or change details plus the most relevant policy sections so the owner can decide fast.

Update Notifications Delivered

When the clause library, supplier change SOP, spec change process, approval matrix, or QA sign-off rules are updated, the module notifies the people impacted based on what they asked and submitted earlier.

A buyer who repeatedly asked about packaging substitutions gets pinged when that exact process changes. Legal gets pinged when approved fallback language is updated. This stops teams from following last year's playbook.

Who It Serves

Procurement buyers, vendor managers, supplier quality, QA sign-off owners, legal counsel, legal ops, compliance, and the business owners who approve exceptions.

Client Snapshot

What They Do

A US-based meat manufacturing and distribution organisation with multiple plants and supplier networks, shipping into retail and foodservice. Procurement and legal decisions touch quality and customer trust daily.

Why These Workflows Are High-Risk

- Supplier and packaging changes happen under shortage pressure
- A wrong substitution can create label, allergen, or quality exposure
- Contract clauses and claims language can create liability exposure
- Approvals exist, but requests are often incomplete and trails are hard to reconstruct

What Was Already in Place

- Supplier SOPs and spec change processes in PDFs
- Legal clause playbooks in shared folders
- Email and Teams for approvals
- A procurement system and a contract repository

The problem was speed and completeness. The system existed, but the decision trail and the correct path were not easy to follow in the moment.

Where the Problem Showed Up

These were the repeat scenes the module was built around.

1

Packaging Substitution Under Shortage

A supplier offers an alternate packaging material because the normal SKU is delayed. Procurement wants to keep production moving. QA wants to ensure the substitution is allowed and documented. Before the module, procurement emailed QA and waited, or proceeded informally and asked QA later.

2

Supplier Change and QA Sign-Off Confusion

A buyer asks, "Do we need QA sign-off for this vendor change or can we proceed if it is the same material category?" Before the module, the answer depended on who was online and which SOP they found.

3

Contract Redlines and Fallback Language

Sales forwards a customer redline, and legal gets asked, "Can we accept this, and what is our approved fallback language?" Before the module, legal spent time finding the relevant clause pack and asking for missing deal context.

4

Approval Requests That Arrive Incomplete

A buyer sends "Need approval" without the site, product category, supplier, reason, risk notes, or required attachments. Before the module, the approver had to ask back, which slowed everything down.

The Pattern We Saw

What Kept Happening

The rule existed, but the decision moment was rushed, and the request was incomplete. People tried to move fast by skipping structure.

> *"Let's do it now, we'll document later"* showed up right before the worst incidents.

Why SOP Reminders Did Not Fix It

Because shortage and customer pressure create urgency. A reminder does not collect missing details, does not attach evidence, and does not route sign-offs correctly.

The workflow needed to do that automatically.

What We Delivered

The Product: Contract and Supplier Change Voice Copilot

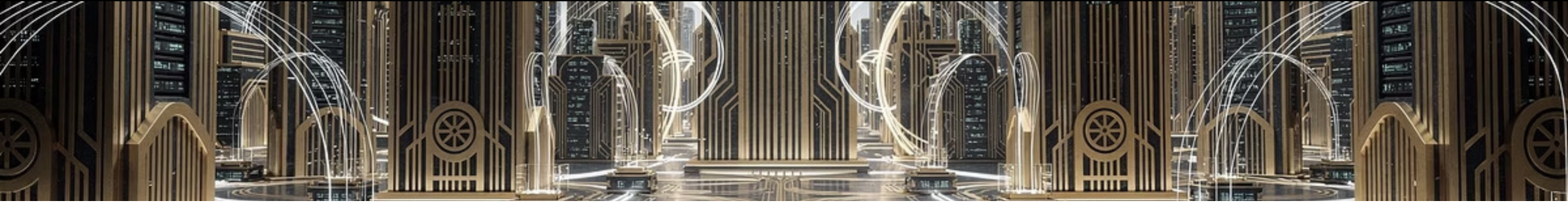
What It Does, in Plain Terms

- The user asks a question by voice inside their daily workflow surface
- The module captures the missing details that change the answer — like site, product line, supplier, material, or clause type
- It returns the correct rule, with the exact section and version it used
- If a sign-off is required, it creates the approval request, notifies the owner, and packages the evidence so the owner can approve without asking basic questions
- Every decision is logged so "who approved this and why" is answerable later

What It Does Not Do

It does not approve a substitution or a clause by guessing.

It does not let a high-risk change proceed without the required checkpoint.



Where It Sits in Their World

1

Surfaces

- Inside Teams for procurement and legal collaboration, because that is where approvals already happen
- Inside the procurement workflow surface for buyers who live in the buying system
- Inside the contract review surface for legal, where clause decisions are tracked

2

Integrations It Reads From

- Supplier SOPs, spec change SOPs, and approval matrices in the document store
- Supplier master and item master from procurement or ERP tools
- Contract clause library and fallback language repository
- Ticketing or approval queue system used for sign-offs
- Directory for routing to the correct QA or legal owner by site and category

3

What It Writes Back

- A structured approval request with required fields filled
- A decision note that includes the policy section and version used
- A clear ownership assignment so the right QA lead or legal owner is accountable
- A trace record that ties the question, the answer, and the approval outcome together

How People Actually Use It

These are the daily interactions it supported.

Packaging Substitution Request

Buyer says, "Supplier offers packaging substitute for this material. Can we approve it for this plant?" The module asks for site and product line if missing, then returns the exact substitution path and whether QA sign-off is required. If sign-off is required, it opens the approval request and notifies the QA owner.

Supplier Change Approval

Vendor manager says, "We want to add a new supplier for this component. What checks and documents are required?" The module returns the checklist and creates a task packet with the required fields.

Contract Fallback Language

Legal gets asked, "Customer wants this recall liability clause. What is our approved fallback?" If approved fallback exists, the module returns it and cites the clause library section. If not, it opens a legal review request with the clause text and deal context attached.

Stop Incomplete Approvals

Buyer tries to submit an approval without including supplier name, site, material type, or reason. The module does not send a vague request. It asks for the missing fields, or marks it incomplete and routes it to the right queue for completion.

Phases the Client Approved

1

Phase 1

Clause lookup and fallback language retrieval with sources shown

2

Phase 2

Supplier and packaging substitution workflow guidance with QA sign-off routing

3

Phase 3

Approval request creation with required fields and owner notifications

4

Phase 4

Decision logging so approvals are traceable by site, category, and owner

5

Phase 5

Update notifications when clause language or substitution rules change

Current Status

✓ Completed

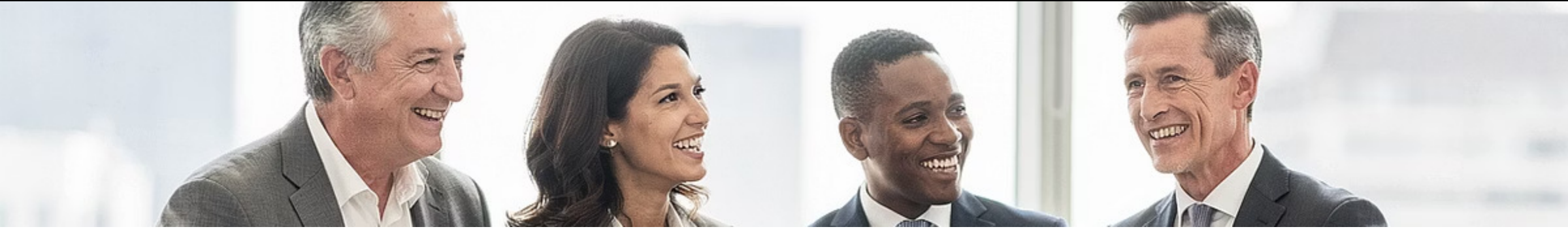
- Clause lookup and fallback language retrieval with section and version shown
- Supplier change and packaging substitution guidance with required detail capture
- Approval request creation with owner notification and evidence attachments
- Decision logs that show what was asked, what rule applied, and who approved
- Update notifications tied to what buyers and legal asked earlier

⍰ Underway

- Tightening category mapping so the module routes to the correct QA owner by plant and product category
- Reducing follow-up questions by pulling more supplier and item detail directly from the procurement system
- Standardising approval packets so QA and legal receive the same structure every time

→ Next

- Expand to more change types, such as label updates, spec revisions, and customer-specific contract addendums
- Add monitoring that highlights repeat "exception" patterns, so leaders can fix the underlying policy gaps
- Extend update notifications to supplier policy changes that affect active packaging and material decisions



Proof Gates

- If site, supplier, category, or clause type is missing, the module does not answer or route without capturing it
- If the relevant SOP section cannot be cited and versioned, the module does not provide an approval path
- If QA or legal sign-off is required, the approval request must be created and the owner must be notified
- If an approval request is missing required fields, it cannot be submitted as complete
- Every approval decision must carry the policy section and version used
- If clause language or substitution rules change, prior requesters must be notified

What We Learned

Routine Moments Were Highest Risk

The highest-risk moments were the ones that sounded routine, like "just swap packaging" or "just accept this clause."

Complete Requests = Faster Approvals

Approvals became faster when the request arrived complete.

Missing Context Was the Real Delay

Most delay was caused by missing context, not slow approvers.

Notifications Prevented Old Playbook Use

Update notifications mattered because buyers kept using old substitution paths under shortage pressure.

Talk to Us

connect via neil.voishift@klyrr.com

What We Will Do

We will wire the **Contract and Supplier Change Voice Copilot** into your procurement and legal workflows so:

- Sign-offs are faster
- Documentation is automatic
- High-risk changes do not slip through on vague messages

Do any of these sound familiar?

- → Do supplier substitutions get pushed through because production is waiting, and QA only hears about it later?
- → Do clause redlines create long threads because nobody can find the approved fallback language fast?
- → Do approvals slow down because requests arrive without the site, category, or evidence needed to decide?
- → Do you have "we cannot prove who approved this" moments after the fact?